A Decision Layer for Perishable Supply Chains

What to buy, what to commit, what to promise, before supply is certain

Rad Al Zubi and Mustafa Sabieha · Industrial Engineering, Purdue University

THE PROBLEM WE ARE WORKING ON

Perishable food operators, meaning midstream distributors, aggregators, and food hubs, commit supply to buyers before they know what their own suppliers will deliver. ERPs and inventory systems record what happened; they were not built to recommend what to commit next. A wrong commitment resolves one of two ways, wasted product or a missed order, and the cost disappears into margin rather than onto a line anyone manages.

WHAT WE BUILT

Three layers on top of the CSV exports an operator already has. A **diagnostic** that puts dollar figures on waste, shortage, supplier fill and rejection, buyer fulfillment, and available-to-promise. A **forecasting layer** for demand and for supplier delivery reliability, with calibrated uncertainty rather than point estimates. And an **optimizer** that treats the weekly buying decision as a two stage problem under uncertainty: commit now, absorb the outcome later through spot purchases, waste, or unmet orders. We validate by backtesting an operator's own history, so the evidence comes from their numbers rather than our claims.

WHERE WE ARE, STATED PLAINLY

The engine is built and gate tested, and the forecasters pass calibration checks. Every result so far comes from a calibrated synthetic operator, roughly 8 million dollars and 28 products over 52 weeks. No real operator's records have touched any layer. We have no customers, and we are not raising money. The bottleneck is a first operator willing to share six to twelve months of history for a free backtest.

OPEN QUESTIONS. ANY ONE OF THESE IS A USEFUL CONVERSATION.

- **Framing.** Is the pre-commitment decision genuinely where margin leaks, or is it already handled well enough by judgment and existing systems? What are we most likely getting wrong about the operation?
- **Measurement.** We value waste at cost and shortage at selling price, then sum them. We apply a 15 to 30 percent recovery band drawn from USDA SR-77 as an explicit assumption. Do those choices survive scrutiny, and should avoidable and unavoidable waste be separated?
- **Economics.** Is a savings figure built this way credible in front of an operator's general manager, and what would an operation of this size actually pay for a tool that produced it?
- **Adoption.** What makes an operator trust a recommendation enough to act on it? What has killed similar tools before they were adopted?
- **Segment.** Which operators feel this most sharply, and which should we deliberately avoid? Does the same logic extend to shelf stable distribution and franchise supply, or does it break there?
- **People and data.** Who else should we be speaking with, and do you know operations that might share historical records for a free, no obligation analysis? We sign an NDA first and use records solely to produce that operator's own report.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

Twenty five to thirty minutes, and your honest read on whichever of the questions above falls closest to your work. We are not seeking an endorsement, and a clear explanation of why the idea is wrong would be as valuable to us right now as encouragement.

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